



PRESIDENT Trump this month levied a 50% tariff on copper imports from Canada. Above, a Montreal plant.

Trump is getting his way on trade

President is reshaping the economic order around view that U.S. has been exploited.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — When President Trump rocked the economy with an unprecedented attack on global trade in April, the plan was dismissed as swaggering, capricious and unsustainable. Market meltdowns and price increases would teach the White House the true cost of its mistakes, economists warned.

Yet, four months later, Trump is largely getting his way, refashioning the global economic order around his long-standing worldview that the United States has been ripped off for decades — all before the economy can fully absorb the shock.

Prices are ticking up, but markets have rebounded, and consumer confidence is resurgent after Trump backed down from his most draconian threats. Projections of a looming recession are being tempered. And a handful of deals have been struck that, on their surface, give Trump much of what he wanted.

Experts still warn that the net effect of Trump's trade war will hurt the U.S. economy, slowing growth and raising prices in the short term while depressing living standards in the long term.

A handful of preliminary agreements with important trading partners have been announced in recent days. But the president said Wednesday that he was committed to raising tariffs on others by Friday.

"THE AUGUST FIRST DEADLINE IS THE AUGUST FIRST DEADLINE — IT STANDS STRONG, AND WILL NOT BE EXTENDED," Trump wrote on social media. "A BIG DAY FOR AMERICA!!!"

That leaves the most valuable U.S. trading relationships — with China, Mexico, Canada and India — vulnerable to devastating rate hikes that could severely roil the U.S. economy by the holiday season, when U.S. retailers make as much as a quarter of their annual sales, experts said. Trump said Wednesday that he would raise the tariff on India to 25%.

The most dramatic pro- [See Trade, A6]

U.S. sees 3% growth in GDP

The second-quarter results come as consumers and firms worry about tariffs. **BUSINESS, A9**

State economy hit by ICE raids

Work attendance is down 3.1% since early June, and experts say more upheaval could hobble businesses

By SUHAUNA HUSSAIN AND MD FAZLUR RAHMAN

As the crackdown on undocumented workers in California approaches a third month, researchers say the effects on the state's economy are already showing.

Since early June, Los Angeles has been roiled by the Trump administration's immigration sweeps. The raids rendered some L.A. neighborhoods ghost towns, with businesses shuttered and customers few and far between, as people stayed home out of fear of being tar-

geted. Even as mass street arrests appear to have slowed, economists warn that continued disruptions could hobble many businesses that rely on immigrant labor. Those not reliant also could see ripple effects, as a lack of such labor disrupts productivity and delays projects, weighing on California's gross domestic product and causing increases in food prices for the rest of the United States.

"If it's true that we are going into a phase in which a lot of these workers are either deported, or scared enough

that they won't go to work, this will be a massive impact," said Giovanni Peri, an international economics professor at UC Davis.

Of course, the state's economy is massive — the equivalent to the fourth largest in the world if it were a country — so it would take a lot to derail it. But the Immigration and Customs Enforcement raids are targeting a crucial motor to the Golden State's success. Economists and business leaders are starting to gather indicators of the actual effects.

[See Raids, A11]



SLICES of an athlete's brain are analyzed for chronic traumatic encephalopathy.

Gunman asked: 'Study my brain'

N.Y. shooter alleged in a suicide note that he had CTE, highlighting risk in youth football.

By KAREN GARCIA AND JENNY JARVIE

Every fall, more than a million young Americans don helmets and padded shoulder pads to play high school football. But this year, questions are intensifying over the risk youth athletes face from repeated head injuries after a gunman who played football in

Southern California claimed he suffered from a degenerative brain disease.

After killing four and taking his own life, Shane Tamera — a former varsity player at two Los Angeles-area high schools — left behind a three-page suicide note, authorities say, alleging he suffered from chronic traumatic encephalopathy.

"Football gave me CTE," Tamera reportedly wrote. "Study my brain please."

It remains unclear whether the 27-year-old actually suffered from CTE, because the disease can only be diagnosed definitively through brain dissection. However, the claim comes at

a time of growing concern over the health risks of contact sports in high school — football in particular.

Caused by repeated head injuries, including concussions and non-concussive impacts, CTE tends to be mostly diagnosed in those who have played football for a decade or longer. However, four years of high school football could expose a player to CTE, said Chris Nowinski, co-founder of the Concussion Legacy Foundation, a nonprofit group that supports athletes and others affected by CTE and concussions.

"The odds of having CTE [See CTE, A7]

Why an 8.8 mega-quake caused so little damage

By RONG-GONG LIN II AND CLARA HARTER

SAN FRANCISCO — It was one of the largest earthquakes ever recorded, a magnitude 8.8 monster off the eastern coast of Russia.

Despite its remote location, the size of the quake immediately brought potential danger of tsunami to a significant swath of the globe, including Japan, Canada and the United States. Tsu-

nami alerts immediately went out, covering millions of people, including the entire U.S. West Coast.

But for all its fury, the quake ended up not being a catastrophe. Dangerous waves that rose more than 10 feet never materialized outside of Russia, and even there, officials had no reports of deaths, and damage appeared to be limited.

"In this case, we mostly dodged a bullet," said Mike Rademaker, harbor master

for the Crescent City Harbor, a place that saw deadly tsunamis both in 1964 with the Alaska mega-quake and 2011 when the great Japanese quake hit.

While those events represent worst-case scenarios, Tuesday's temblor represents a best-case scenario.

"With tsunamis, location and directionality is everything," said Nathan Wood, a tsunami scientist with the U.S. Geological Survey.

The area near the epicen-

Harris won't join California governor's race

Former vice president says she won't run for Gavin Newsom's seat in the 2026 election.

By LAURA J. NELSON, SEEMA MEHTA AND JULIA WICK

After months of speculation about her political future, former Vice President and San Francisco Bay Area native Kamala Harris has ruled out one option: governor of California.

Harris said Wednesday that she will not enter the 2026 race to replace Gov. Gavin Newsom, who is serving his second term and cannot run again. Harris did not say what she plans to do next, but her choice is the clearest sign yet that she may still be considering a third run for president.

"I love this state, its people, and its promise. It is my home. But after deep reflection, I've decided that I will not run for governor in this election," Harris said in a statement. "For now, my leadership — and public service — will not be in elected office. I look forward to getting back out and listening to the American people, helping elect Democrats across the nation who will fight fearlessly, and sharing more details in the months ahead about my own plans."

Since her loss to President Trump in November, Harris, 60, has spent most of

this year out of the public eye, settling back into life in Brentwood and speaking with confidants about her options: run for president for a third time in 2028, launch a gubernatorial campaign or end a two-decade career in elected office and enter the private sector.

She has largely eschewed the limelight, occasionally critiquing Trump's actions but hardly positioning herself as a face of the resistance. In recent months, she has greeted graduating high school seniors in Compton, made a surprise appearance at the Met Gala in New York City and attended Apple co-founder Steve Jobs' daughter's wedding in the English countryside over the weekend. She has also reportedly written a memoir and is considering starting a nonprofit focused on young voters and democracy or a political action committee to help Democrats.

Serving as the governor of California, a bulwark in the anti-Trump movement, would have given Harris another shot at her political rival and an opportunity to rewrite the end of her political story after a barrier-breaking career.

Harris was the first woman to be elected district attorney of San Francisco, the first woman to be elected California attorney general, the first woman of color to be elected to the U.S. Senate from California and the first woman elected vice president of the United States.

[See Harris, A14]

U.S. moves to drop charges in Essayli's office

Prosecutors seek to dismiss cases against a Trump donor and a sheriff's deputy.

By BRITTNY MEJIA AND JAMES QUEALLY

Just hours after the Trump administration moved to extend U.S. Atty. Bill Essayli's term as Los Angeles' top federal law enforcement official, prosecutors moved to dismiss charges in a pair of controversial criminal cases, including one involving a donor to the president.

In a motion filed late Tuesday, federal prosecutors sought to dismiss an indictment accusing Andrew Wiederhorn, former chief executive of the company that owns the Fatburger and Johnny Rockets chains, of carrying out a \$47-million "sham loan" scheme. Prosecutors also sought to dismiss charges against L.A. County Sheriff's Deputy Trevor Kirk, who has already been convicted and sentenced in an excessive force case after he attacked a woman in a supermarket parking lot in 2023.

A spokesman for the U.S.

attorney's office declined to comment. Both cases sparked significant controversy during Essayli's turbulent run as L.A.'s top federal prosecutor.

Days before Essayli's initial appointment in April, Adam Schleifer, the assistant U.S. attorney handling the criminal case against Wiederhorn, was fired at the behest of the White House.

Schleifer alleged in appealing the decision that his firing was motivated in part by his prosecution of Wiederhorn, a donor to President Trump who has maintained his innocence.

According to three sources familiar with the matter who were not authorized to speak on the record, [See Essayli, A7]

Pigs play role in finding the lost

Their bodies serve as proxies as Mexico tests new technologies to search for the disappeared. **SCIENCE, A8**

A move to bar masked agents

County seeks to ban law enforcers from hiding their identities. Critics see holes in the plan. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Local surge in venture capital

Defense tech company Anduril leads with \$2.5 billion raised in the second quarter. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 86/63. **B6**

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